shall defeat them near Ghazni (Bactrian Inscription from Yakawlang sheds new light on history of Buddhism in Afghanistan, 2003).

We have an interesting record from AD 726. The Korean Buddhist monk Hyecho had visited Zabulistan (Xièyùguó) and had recorded that Kābul and Zabul were ruled by Buddhist Turkic kings. He also stated that the King of Zabul was nephew of the king of Kābul (Daryaee, 2021). Below is the text from his records:

> *From Kapisa I travelled further west and after seven days arrived at the country of Zabulistan which its people call She-hu-lo-sa-t'a-na. The native are Hu people; the king and cavalry are Turks. The king, a nephew of the king of Kapisa, himself controls his tribe and the cavalry stationed in this country. It is not subject to other countries, not even his own uncle. Though the king and the chiefs are Turks, they highly revere the Three Jewels. There are many monasteries and monks. Mahayana Buddhism is practiced. There is a great Turkish chief called Sha-tuo-kan, who once a year lays out his gold and silver, which is much more than the king possesses. The dress, customs, and products of this land are similar to those of Kapisa, but the languages are different.*
>
> —Hyecho on Zabulistan in "An account of travel to the five Indian kingdoms." (Jain, 2011)

According to the Islamic Traditional account (written around a century after the incidence), after the Abbasids came to power in AD 750, the Zunbils submitted to the third Abbasid Caliph al-Mahdi (AD 775–785). But this account seems to be largely fictional in nature which was perhaps created to merely to show the power the caliphate. The contemporary incidences show that the people of the region continued to resist to be ruled by Muslims. The Muslim historian ʻAbū l-'Abbās ʻAḥmad bin ʻAbī Ya'qūb bin Ǧa'far bin Wahb bin Waḍīḥ al-Yaʿqūbī (died AD 897/8) recounts after a century of the alleged event that al-Mahdi asked for, and apparently obtained, the submission of various Central Asian rulers, including that of the Zunbils. The original account by Ya'qubi reads as below:

> *Al-Mahdī sent messengers to the kings, calling on them to submit, and most of them submitted to him. Among them were the king of Kābul Shāh, whose name was Ḥanḥal; the king of Ṭabaristān, the Iṣbahbadh; the king of Soghdia, the Ikhshīd; the king of Tukhāristān, Sharwin; the king of Bamiyan, the Shīr; the king of Farghana, — ; the king of Usrūshana, Afshīn; the king of the Kharlukhiyya, Jabghūya; the king of Sijistān, Zunbīl; the king of Turks, Tarkhan; the king of Tibet, Ḥ-h-w-r-n; the king of Sind, al-Rāy; the king of China, Baghbür; the king of India and Atrāḥ, Wahūfūr; and the king of the Tughuz-ghuz, Khāqān.*
>
> —Ya'qubi (died AD 897/8), Ta'rikh (Mathew S Gordon, 2018)

As per the contemporary records, the Arabs were able to obtain tribute from the Zunbils in AD 769, which shall happen after almost half a century when Ma'n b. Za'ida al-Shaybanl shall defeat them near Ghazni (Bactrian